functionality, including analytics, dashboarding, and business diagnostics. Splunk is heavily invested in and contributes to OpenTelemetry, and hence, it comes as no surprise that it provides first-class support for it in its products.

- *Sumo Logic (https://www.sumologic.com/)*—An SaaS offering integrated with all major cloud providers. It comes with many integrations, supporting a range of use cases with monitoring and security-related functionality and supports OpenTelemetry as well.

With that, we've reached the end of the all-in-one offerings and now move on to considerations when selecting one.

6.3 Selecting frontends and all-in-ones

Given the sheer number of options for frontends and all-in-ones you've seen in this chapter, you could imagine it's not an easy task to pick one (or more). If you can, work backward from the value you want to deliver to your internal customers, developers, and business stakeholders. Consider the following questions: Are you looking for a solution to support the acceleration of shipping features and fixing bugs? Are you interested in a product that allows you to reduce the time to fix an issue in prod? Do you want to increase developer productivity?

Depending on the answers, you first want to make a decision on the following: build or buy. In general, unless you've identified this as a competitive advantage, you want to outsource as much as possible. In other words, buy. There are several big enterprises, however, that have a strategic interest in minimizing their dependence on vendors and/or a cloud provider. In this context, using open source (components) and basing the work on open standards makes a lot of sense. In other words, build.

Your mileage may vary, but here a couple of considerations when you evaluate and select offerings in this space:

- Can you determine the costs? Costs of frontends are typically on a per-user basis (viewer and editor) in a hosted offering and relatively predictable. All-in-ones typically have backend-like cost plans (and may have seat-based pricing). For self-hosted setups, make sure you take into account the operational costs of patching, scaling, on-call hours, security-related requirements and work, as well as keeping up with upstream. There may also be costs associated with data storage, ingestion, and query, as we discussed in chapter 5 in greater detail.
- All-in-ones are typically the closest you can get for a single pane of glass, and if you make sure open standards, such as OpenTelemetry, are supported, minimizing vendor lock-in, they are an excellent choice.
- For all open source offerings, make sure you understand who is behind the project (i.e., a single vendor open source versus a community, usually hosted by CNCF or ASF), the licensing (which can potentially change), and the health of the open source project. Concerning the last point, simply looking at how many